

Attenuation: refers to the reduction of power of the light signal as it travels through the fiber. It is also called transmission losses. It determines maximum transmission distances.

input optical power = P_i

output " " = P_o

∴ Number of decibels (dB) = $10 \log_{10} \frac{P_i}{P_o}$

Power & roots reduces to multiplication & division.

Addition & subtraction require a conversion to numerical values which may be obtained.

→ numerical value = $\frac{P_i}{P_o} = 10^{(dB/10)}$

$$\rightarrow \alpha_{dB} = 10 \log \frac{P_i}{P_o} \text{ dB km}^{-1}$$

where, α_{dB} is the signal attenuation per unit.

Material absorption: material absorption is a loss mechanism related to the material composition & fabrication process for the fiber. which results in the dissipation of some of the transmitted optical power as heat in the ^{wave} ~~web~~guide.

This reduces the transmitted optical power.

— Type of absorption — interaction with
1) Intrinsic → caused by the [↑] one or more of the major components of the glass. (caused by the natural properties of the fiber material → usually silica glass).

Two main region →
— UV absorption (short wavelength)
— IR absorption (long wavelength)

→ OH (hydroxyl ions) from water dissolve into glass.

2) Extrinsic Absorption → (caused by the impurities within the glass) → (impurities in the fiber manufacturing).

- Fabrication process. or time (24).
common impurities - Metal ion (Fe, Cu), (OH⁻).

* Explain in details the intrinsic absorption loss mechanism with necessary illustration → def: - caused by the interaction with one or more major components of the glass - called intrinsic absorption.

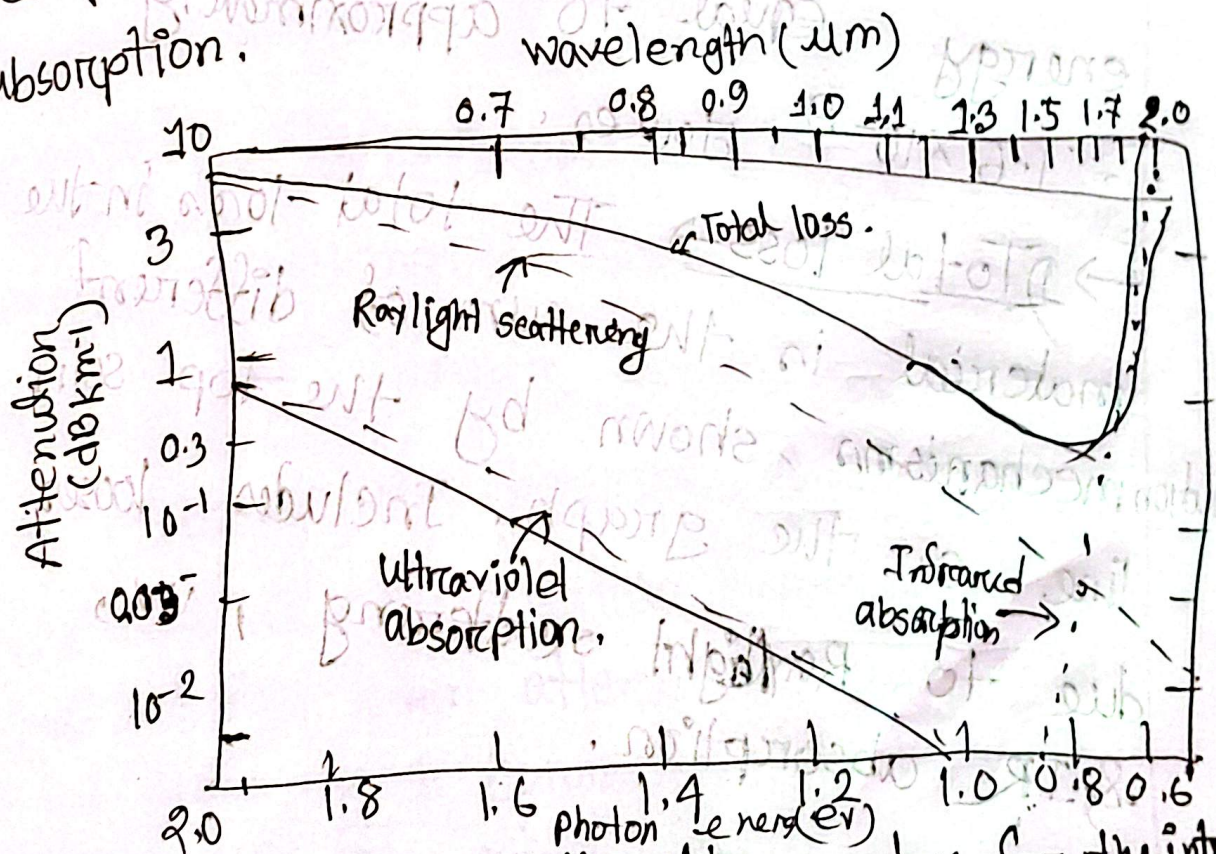


Fig: The attenuation spectra for the intrinsic

mechanism in pure $\text{GeO}_2\text{-SiO}_2$ glass.

→ The graph shows the attenuation spectra for the intrinsic loss mechanism in pure $\text{GeO}_2\text{-SiO}_2$ glass, which is commonly used in optical fibers. The attenuation is measured in dB/km and plotted against both photon energy (eV) & wavelength (μm)

→ The electronvolt is a unit of energy equal to approximately 1.6×10^{-19} joules.

→ Total loss → The total loss in the material is the sum of different attenuation mechanisms, shown by the top solid line on the graph. Includes losses due to Rayleigh scattering, UV, & IR absorption.

2) Rayleigh Scattering $\rightarrow$ curve causes attenuation due to imperfection & variations in the glass structure.

The Rayleigh scattering curve decreases as the wavelength increases, showing that the effect is more prominent at shorter wavelengths.

3) UV $\xrightarrow{\text{absorption}}$ is an electromagnetic radiation with a wavelength from 10 nm to 400 nm, shorter than that of visible light but longer than X-Rays.

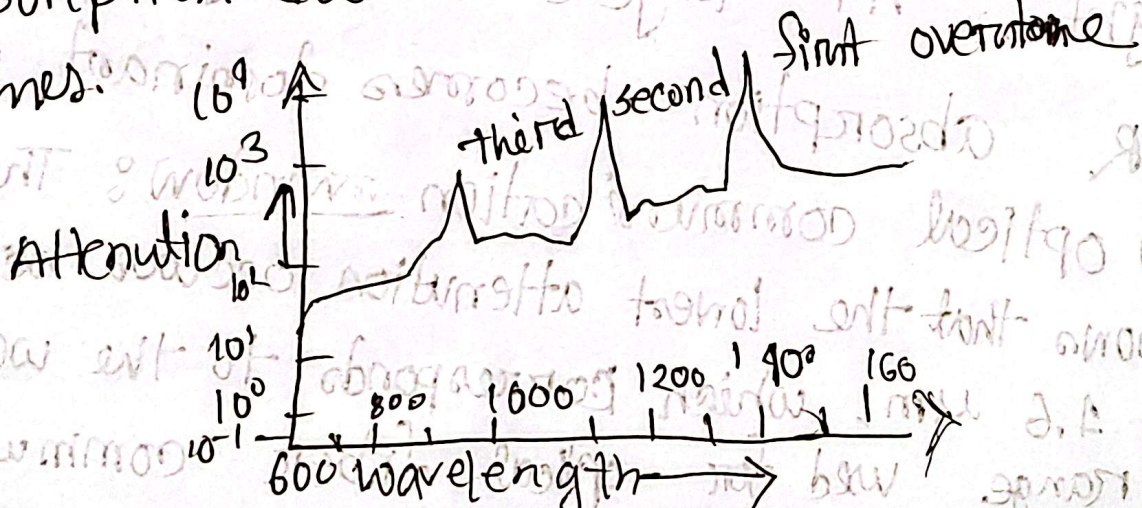
4) IR: is electromagnetic radiation (EMR) longer wavelengths than those of visible light. At longer wavelength (beyond 1.6 μm) IR absorption becomes dominant.

5) optical communication window: The graph shows that the lowest attenuation occurs between 0.8 μm & 1.6 μm , which corresponds to the wavelength range used for optical fiber communication.

This is because both Rayleigh scattering & infrared absorption are minimized in this range, leading to optimal performance.

* Absorption ~~losses~~ losses caused by some of the more common metallic ion impurities, namely Chromium (Cr) & (Cu) in the worst valence state can cause attenuation in excess of 1 dB km^{-1} in the infrared region.

* Extrinsic (OH^-) - Another major extrinsic loss mechanism is caused by absorption due to water OH^- dissolved in glasses.



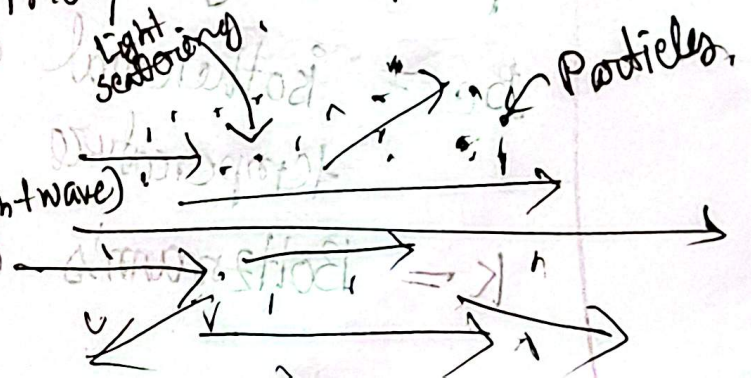
✓ Absorption losses caused by some of the more common metallic ion impurities of, in glasses, together with the absorption peak wavelength. — namely Cr & Cu in worst valence state can cause attenuation in excess of 1 dB km^{-1} in the near infrared region.

✓ Linear scattering losses → Linear scattering mechanism are processes in which some or all of the optical power from one propagating mode is transferred to another mode in a linear manner.

→ The transfer of power often leads to attenuation because the light may be coupled into —

① Leaky modes:

② Radiation modes (Light wave)



→ These mode does not continue to propagated within the fiber core, but is radiated from the fiber.

Rayleigh scattering — is the elastic scattering of light or other electromagnetic radiation by particles much smaller than wavelength of the radiation.

$$\gamma_R = \frac{8\pi^3}{3\lambda^4} n^8 p^2 \beta_c k T_f$$

γ_R = Rayleigh scattering coefficient.

λ = optical wavelength.

n = refractive index of medium.

p = average photoelastic coefficient

β_c = isothermal compressibility at effective temperature T_f .

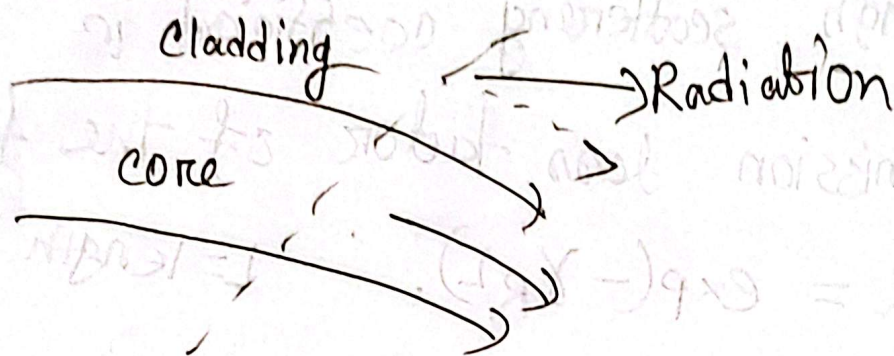
k = Boltzmann's constant

Rayleigh scattering coefficient is related to transmission loss factor of the fiber α .

$$\alpha = \exp(-\alpha_R L). \quad L = \text{length of the fiber.}$$

Fiber bend loss $\rightarrow$ Optical fibers experience radiation loss when they are bent or curved along their path. This happens because part of the light energy, present in the evanescent field, extends into the cladding.

$\rightarrow$ at the bend exceeding the velocity of light in the cladding and hence the guidance mechanism is inhibited, which causes light energy to be radiated from the fiber.



→ ~~Different~~ mode fiber.

→ Radiation attenuation coefficient

$$\alpha_r = C_1 \exp(-C_2 R)$$

R = radius of curvature of fiber bend

C_1, C_2 = constant in multimode fibers at a critical radius of curvature R_c

$$R_c = \frac{3n_1^2 a}{4\pi(n_1^2 - n_2^2)^{3/2}}$$

Simulated Brillouin scattering :-

$$P_B = 4.4 \times 10^{-3} a^2 \alpha_B V \text{ watts}$$

Raman scattering - $P_R = 5.9 \times 10^{-2} a^2 \alpha_R W$

* What is an optical attenuation used for -

1. Evaluating transmission distance: Optical attenuation helps determine the maximum distance an optical signal can travel through.

2. Compare with metallic conductor: It allows for comparing fiber optics with metallic cable. Lower attenuation in fiber make them more suitable for long distance communication.

3. Signal quality assessment: Attenuation measure the reduction in signal strength, which helps assess and maintain quality.

4. System design & optimization: Knowing attenuation of fiber optic we can ensure they are optimized for distance.

5. Loss mechanism Analysis: Understanding attenuation helps to address various loss mechanism.

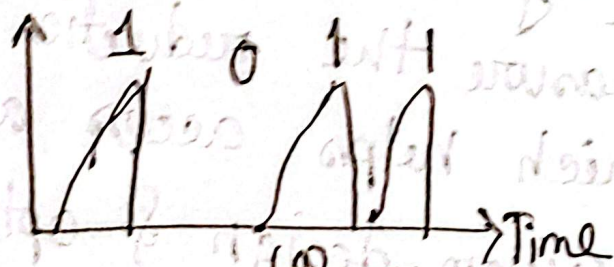
the reduction of the signal

6. Performance Monitoring $\rightarrow$ Regular attenuation measurement help monitor & maintain the performance of the fiber optic network.

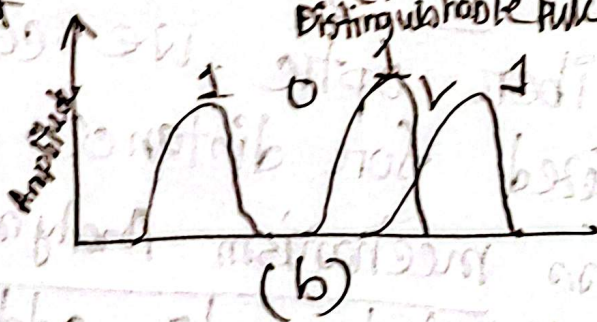
Dispersion: refers to the spreading of light pulse as they travel down the fiber. It causes distortion for both digital & analog transmission.

a) fiber input

Amplitude



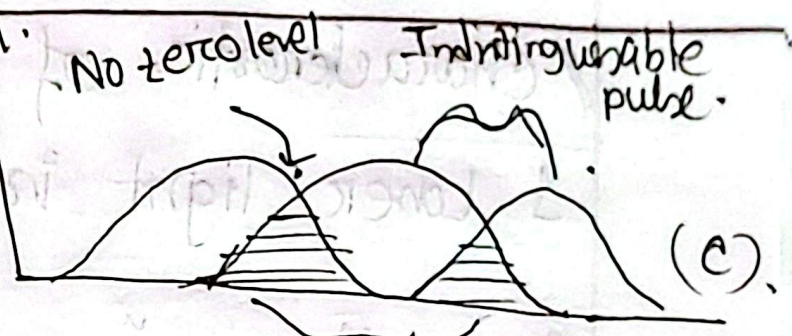
b) fiber output at a distance L_1



(a) Distinguishable pulse.

(b)

(c) fiber output at a distance $L_2 > L_1$



— an illustration using digital bit 1011 of broadening of light.

(a) fiber input (b) fiber output at a distance L , (c) fiber output at distance $L_2 > L_1$

∴ The energy difference due to the transition of electron leads two processes

1. Radiative process : In this process photons are emitted.

2. Non radiative process : Process lead to the creating of heat.

